

HCI DESIGN REVIEW OF CANVA

Assignment: AI-Agent Based HCI Design Review

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A. System Description

System Name: Canva

Users: Students, teachers, designers, and other people who create visual content.

Goal: To help users create presentations, posters, and other designs.

Main Task: A student wants to select a presentation template, edit its content, add images, and download the finished presentation.

Context: The student uses Canva through a web browser on a laptop to prepare a university assignment, possibly with limited time and experience using design software.

B. Five Possible HCI/Usability Problems

1. Difficulty finding the correct template

New users may find it difficult to select a suitable presentation template from the available options.

HCI principle: Recognition rather than recall.

2. Difficulty understanding editing tools

Some users may not immediately understand the purpose of certain icons or editing controls.

HCI principle: Visibility of system status and clear affordances.

3. Accidental changes to design elements

Users may unintentionally move, resize, or modify an object while editing a design.

HCI principle: Error prevention.

4. Difficulty locating download settings

Users may need extra time to find the correct file format or download option.

HCI principle: Consistency and standards; efficiency of use.

5. Uncertainty about whether changes are saved

Users may be unsure whether their latest edits have been saved successfully.

HCI principle: Visibility of system status.

C. AI Agent Analysis: Five Improvement Ideas

1. Improve template discovery. Make categories and relevant search filters easy to identify.

Evidence needed: Inspect the template-selection screen and test whether users can find a suitable template efficiently.

2. Clarify editing controls. Provide descriptive labels or tooltips for unfamiliar icons.

Evidence needed: Inspect the editing toolbar and test whether new users understand the controls.

3. Make accidental edits easier to recover from. Ensure undo, redo, and relevant recovery controls are discoverable.

Evidence needed: Inspect the editor and test whether users can recover from a deliberate editing mistake.

4. Simplify the download workflow. Make export options and file formats easy to locate and understand.

Evidence needed: Complete a test download and record the steps needed to find the appropriate format.

5. Communicate save status clearly. Display understandable feedback about whether changes have been saved.

Evidence needed: Observe the actual save-status indicators and test how users interpret them.

D. Verification Against HCI Principles

Each improvement must be checked against the actual interface rather than accepted simply because an AI suggested it.

- Recognition rather than recall: Can users identify the right option without memorizing where it is?
- Visibility of system status: Does the interface clearly communicate what is happening?

- Error prevention and recovery: Can users avoid mistakes and recover from them?
- Consistency and standards: Do controls behave in predictable ways?
- Efficiency of use: Can users complete the task without unnecessary steps?

Record each observation, take a screenshot, and distinguish between directly observed evidence and assumptions.

AI-Use Log

Stage	AI use	Human verification
Initial analysis	Generated possible usability problems	Compared each problem with the actual interface
Improvement ideas	Suggested five possible improvements	Checked feasibility and relevance
HCI evaluation	Identified relevant HCI principles	Confirmed whether each principle applied
Final recommendations	Helped organize the findings	Selected recommendations based on collected evidence

F. Screenshots and AI-Use Log

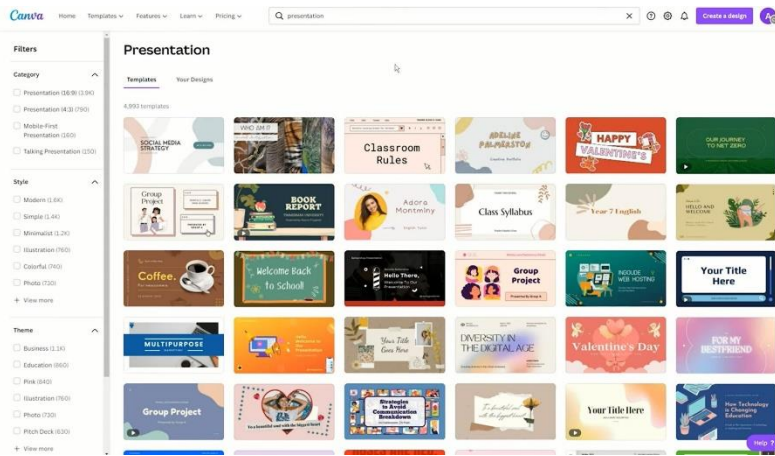
Include screenshots of:

Screenshot 1 — Template selection

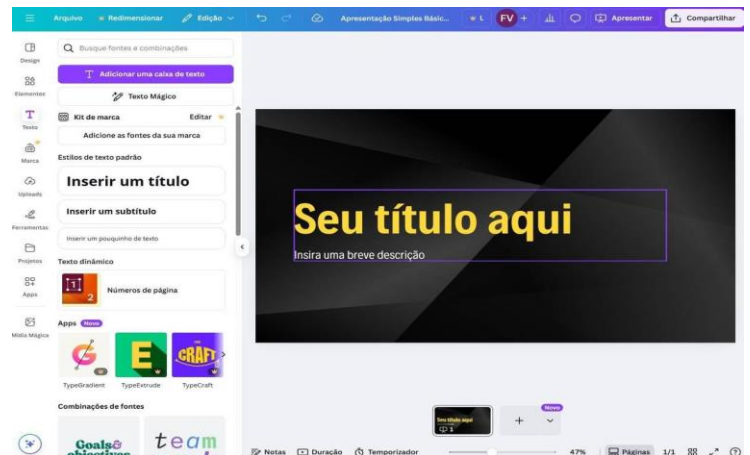
Screenshot 2 — Editing interface

Screenshot 3 — Download options

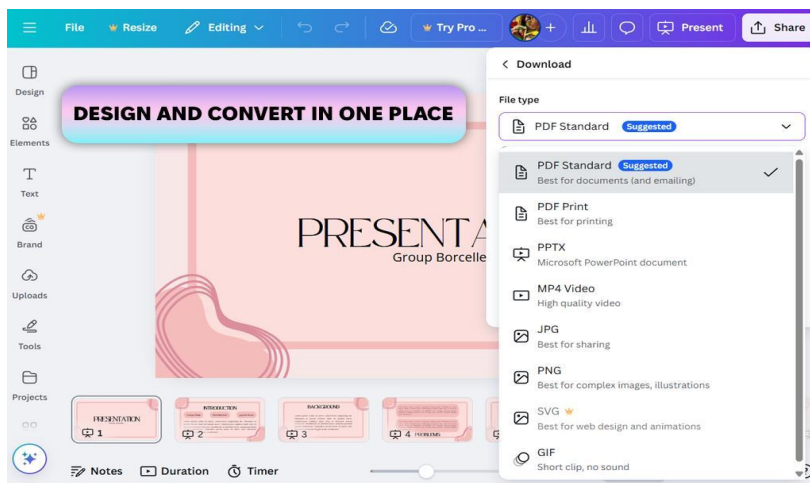
Screenshot 1 — Template selection



Screenshot 2 — Editing interface



Screenshot 3 — Download options



Conclusion: An AI agent can help identify potential usability problems and generate design improvements. However, human verification is necessary to ensure that recommendations are accurate, practical, and supported by evidence.

